Find the new tools

For individuals, supporters, caregivers, administrators and case managers. These two tools serve different purposes and keep information connected to the selected individual.

A Caregiver entry points



B Individual entry points



Illustrative screen mockups with fictional examples. Excerpts show relevant controls; scroll in the app to see the complete screen.

1. On the caregiver dashboard, scroll through Quick Actions. Open How I Communicate for communication guidance, or Understanding My Support Needs to prepare information for professional planning.

2. In My STAR, open How I Communicate or What Helps Me. What Helps Me opens the support preparation workspace.

3. On either feature page, check the name in Individual before reading or saving anything. A caregiver with access to several people selects the intended person. An individual account is limited to its own linked profile.

4. The individual may use an authorized caregiver's signed-in phone or tablet. Keep their actual answers separate from the supporter's observations; the saved entry identifies the real recorder.

The features described here are available in UVM Testing. Use fictional information in that environment. Each new individual profile starts blank; another person's answers and support strategies are not copied into it.

How I Communicate personal answers

Help the individual describe what makes communication easier. Participation is voluntary; completing every question is not required.

A Answer one question at a time



B Find the saved contribution



Illustrative screen mockups with fictional examples. Excerpts show relevant controls; scroll in the app to see the complete screen.

1. Open How I Communicate, verify Individual, and select My view. Read the question or tap Read to me.

2. Tap any choices that fit. Tap a selected choice again to remove it. Add the individual's own words by typing, Dictate, or the keyboard microphone. Use I'm not sure or Skip this question when appropriate.

3. Use Next question and Back to move through the nine questions. Answers are retained while navigating this page. The optional For my helper area records how assistance was provided.

4. Tap Save my answers when the person is ready. Save is available before all questions are answered. Wait for the saved confirmation.

5. To find the answer later, open For my team and expand Individual answers & team observations. The entry shows the individual's words separately, along with assistance and recorder information.

An individual's contribution is not automatically published as team guidance. A helper should enter only what the person actually communicated, including through gestures or pictures.

How I Communicate team guidance

Caregivers read and contribute observations. Administrators maintain the published guide for the selected individual.



Illustrative screen mockups with fictional examples. Excerpts show relevant controls; scroll in the app to see the complete screen.

1. Open For my team. Read the individual-specific statement and Start here guidance. Expand Communication dictionary to read signals, what they might mean, and what has helped.

2. Administrators select Edit team guide. Enter information in the relevant optional fields: communication, choices, harder moments, engagement, first contact, tools, settings, detailed information, source reference and review guidance.

3. In Communication dictionary, tap Add a signal. Enter the actual words or action, a possible meaning, and the response that has helped. Remove an unused signal row when needed.

4. Check every entry against this person's needs. Tap Publish guide for the individual. Publication creates a new version; expand Published guide history to read earlier versions.

5. Other caregivers use Suggest an update to submit proposed wording. Administrators review the suggestion and separately edit/publish any agreed change.

Mark reviewed records that the item was reviewed. It does not rewrite the person's words, automatically publish a suggestion, or establish professional approval. Possible meanings must remain possibilities, not assumed facts.

Record observations and orient new supporters

Use dated observations to help the team learn what works for this individual. Use published guidance to introduce their communication needs to new supporters.

A Record observable details



B Share an orientation guide



Illustrative screen mockups with fictional examples. Excerpts show relevant controls; scroll in the app to see the complete screen.

1. In For my team, select Record what helped. Enter What I noticed, What support I offered, and What happened next. All three are needed to save the observation.

2. Add the individual's exact words when available. Keep any possible meaning in the separate optional interpretation field. Tap Save observation for team review and wait for confirmation.

3. Expand Individual answers & team observations to read the dated record. An administrator may Mark reviewed; the shared guide remains unchanged until it is separately edited and published.

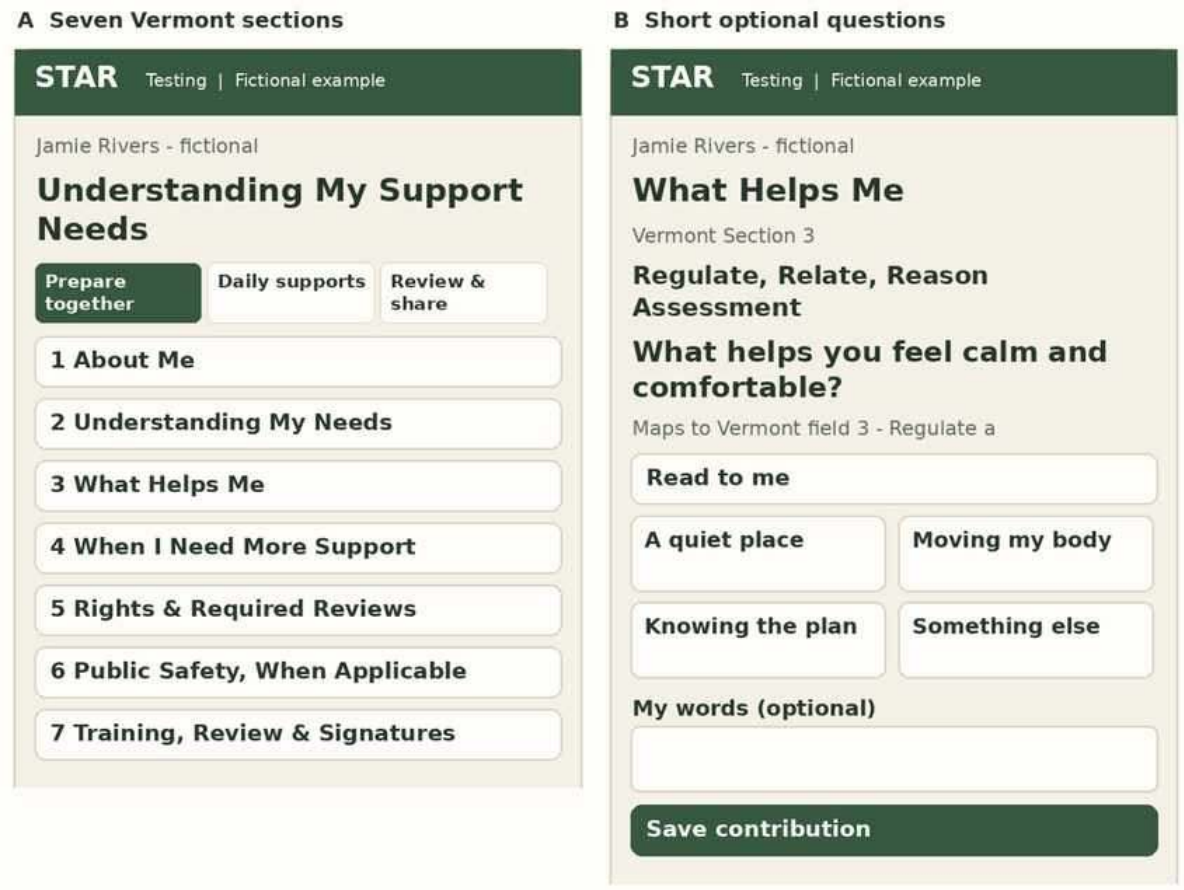
4. For orientation, select First-contact guide. Read the selected individual's published first-contact information and related communication supports. If the team has not added a guide, no personal instructions will be available.

5. Use Print this guide from first contact, or Print guide in team view. In the browser print dialog, choose a printer or Save as PDF when available. Follow your team's process for sharing personal information.

The first-contact guide is intended to help new staff and relevant medical or public-safety workers understand the individual. Pending observations are not printed as published guidance.

Prepare for a professional conversation

Understanding My Support Needs is a helpful place to start before requesting a therapeutic evaluation or plan. Professional support can be requested at any point; completing this workspace is not a prerequisite.



Illustrative screen mockups with fictional examples. Excerpts show relevant controls; scroll in the app to see the complete screen.

1. Open Understanding My Support Needs from the caregiver dashboard, or What Helps Me from My STAR. Verify the selected individual and choose Prepare together.

2. Open any of the seven sections. They follow Vermont's template: About Me; Understanding My Needs; What Helps Me; When I Need More Support; Rights & Required Reviews; Public Safety, When Applicable; and Training, Review & Signatures.

3. Read the displayed Vermont section and field reference. Use Choose a question to jump within that section, or Next question and Previous to move one question at a time.

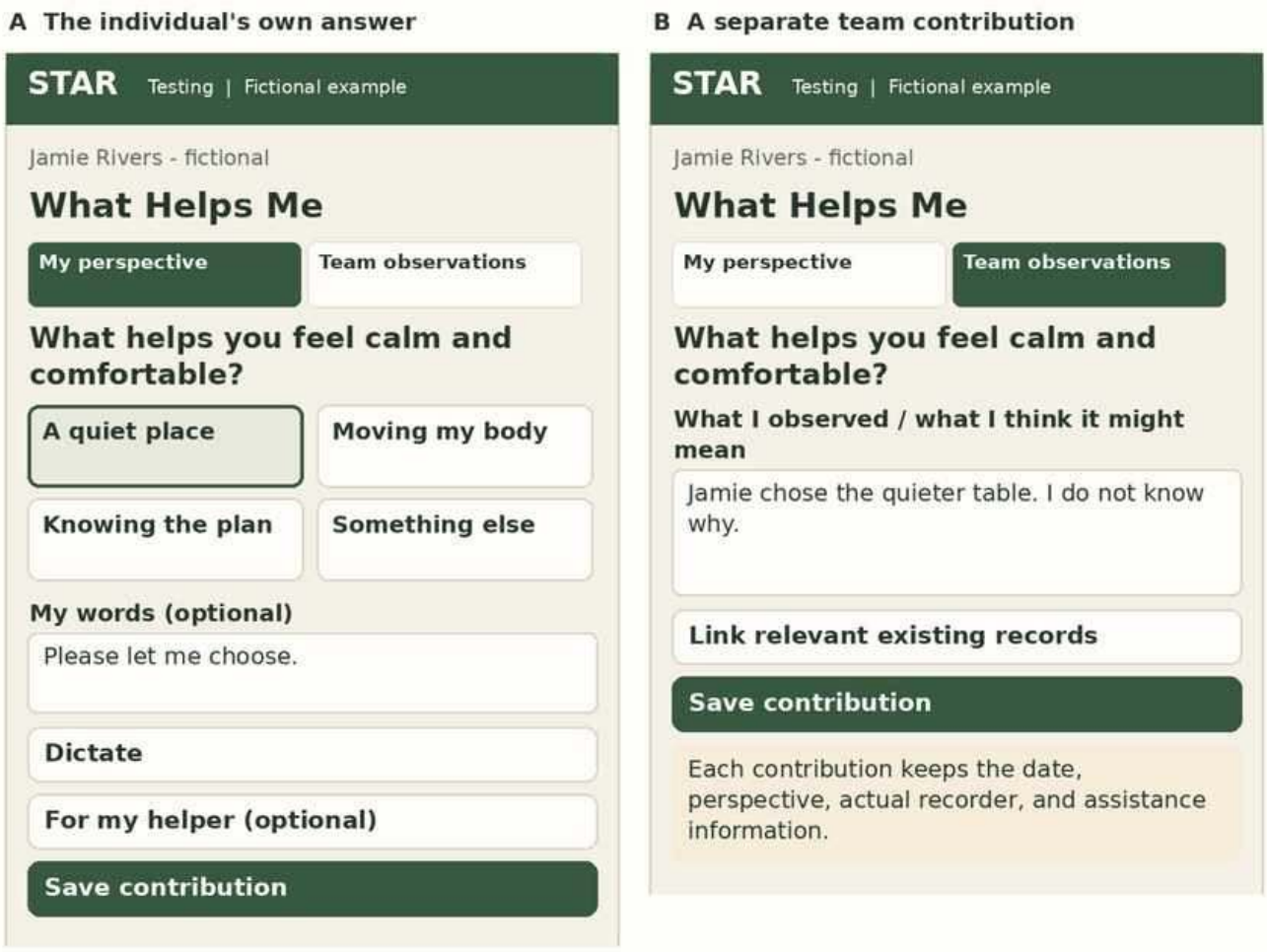
4. Answer only what is useful and comfortable. A question about sensitive history may simply be answered with a request for a private professional conversation. Leave unanswered questions for later.

5. Use All sections or Leave for another time to return to the section list. Save contribution before closing the page if you want the current answer stored.

The 34 optional questions gather preparation material. They do not complete a clinical assessment, produce new crisis instructions, authorize restrictions, or create an approved Therapeutic Support Plan.

Keep the individual voice distinct

Within a question, an authorized supporter may help the individual contribute and may separately record the team's observations.



Illustrative screen mockups with fictional examples. Excerpts show relevant controls; scroll in the app to see the complete screen.

1. Select My perspective when recording the individual's answer. Use Read to me, available choices, My words and Dictate as helpful. No choice is selected in advance.

2. Open For my helper if assistance was provided. Choose how the answer was recorded. Enter what the person actually expressed rather than guessing an answer.

3. For a supporter's separate account, choose Team observations. Describe what was observed and clearly identify any interpretation or uncertainty. An individual account does not offer a team-observation mode.

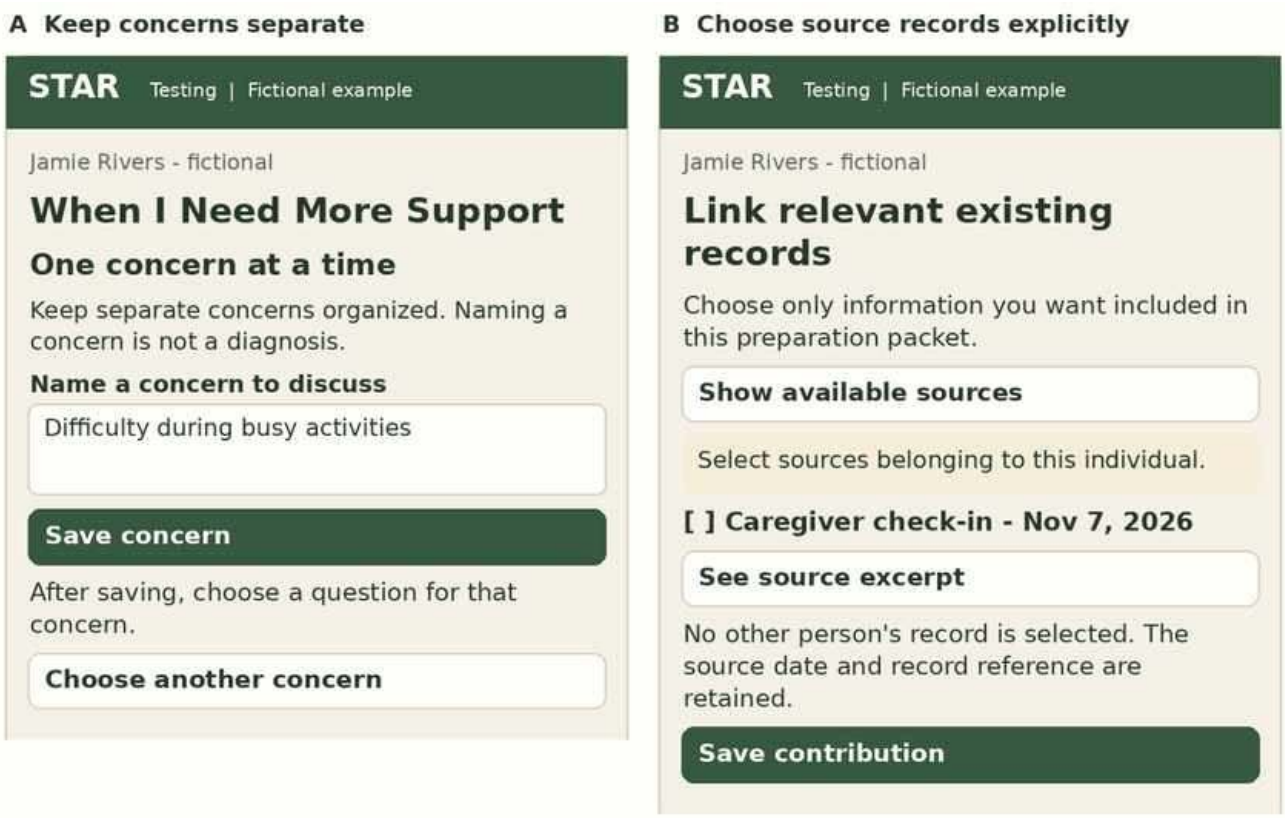
4. Tap Save contribution and wait for confirmation. Saving adds a dated entry with the perspective, actual recorder and assistance. It does not change a communication guide or formal plan.

5. Expand the saved-contributions area beneath the question to read earlier entries. Add a new contribution to clarify or correct an earlier entry; original words remain intact.

Unsaved words and choices stay on this page while moving between questions. They are not a cross-device draft. Save each contribution before leaving, signing out, refreshing, or changing devices.

Organize concerns and link evidence

Section 4 keeps each concern separate. Existing communication and check-in information can be selected as source material instead of rewritten.



Illustrative screen mockups with fictional examples. Excerpts show relevant controls; scroll in the app to see the complete screen.

1. In When I Need More Support, select an existing concern or enter a short name under Name a concern to discuss. Tap Save concern. Naming a concern is not a diagnosis.

2. Answer the questions for that concern. Use Choose another concern to work on a different issue. Save each contribution to preserve its connection to the selected concern.

3. When a question offers Link relevant existing records, expand it and tap Show available sources. Sources appear only when explicitly connected to this individual.

4. Use See source excerpt to read the information. Select the checkbox only for records you want included, up to ten sources per contribution. Available lists show recent records, not every historical record.

5. Tap Save contribution to save your answer and selected source excerpts together. Source dates and references remain separate from your own words.

Unassigned legacy check-ins and another person's records are excluded. The check-in excerpt includes recorded caregiver, physical and behavior notes and sleep hours when available; it is not an export of the whole check-in. If sources do not load, the contribution can still be saved without them.

Review and share the preparation packet

Individuals, caregivers and case managers can use saved contributions to prepare for a conversation with the chosen qualified professional.

A Review saved contributions



B Preview and export the outline



Illustrative screen mockups with fictional examples. Excerpts show relevant controls; scroll in the app to see the complete screen.

1. Open Review & share. Expand a section to read its saved contributions, dates, perspectives, recorder information, assistance and linked source excerpts.

2. Tap Preview Vermont document outline. The same saved contributions appear beside their Vermont sections. Blank sections remain outstanding; a saved contribution does not mean a section is professionally complete.

3. To print, select Print / Save PDF from the outline. Choose the printer, paper options and page range in your browser's print dialog. Select Save as PDF if your device provides it.

4. To save text, select Download preparation packet (.txt) in Review & share, or Download all sections (.txt) in the outline. Open the download in your device's Files or Downloads app.

5. Review the packet before sharing it through your team's agreed process. Downloading or printing does not automatically email, post, submit or send it to anyone.

The packet is clearly labeled preparation material. It is not the completed official Vermont form, a professional evaluation, or an approved plan. Daily supports points to existing team documents and How I Communicate; preparation answers do not become active care instructions.

Save access and device help

When an answer is not visible

1. Confirm the correct testing site and signed-in account. Check Individual again; each person's records are separate.

2. For communication answers, use For my team and expand Individual answers & team observations. For preparation answers, use Review & share or the saved-contributions area under the original question.

3. If no individual is linked, ask the group administrator to check the individual's profile and team role. Do not create a second personal profile just to bypass the message.

When a save is not confirmed

Keep the page open. Use Save again to check or retry the original entry. The app reuses the same submission identifier and checks for an existing saved record. Wait for confirmation before leaving or re-entering the answer. Do not repeatedly create new submissions. If the sign-in expired, retain your words and sign back in before continuing.

Read aloud and dictation

Tap Read to me and make sure the device volume is audible and the browser is permitted to play audio. For Dictate, allow microphone access if the device asks, speak, then stop dictation and check the text. If browser dictation is unavailable, tap the text box and use the microphone on the phone or tablet keyboard, or type. Read aloud and dictation are different functions; neither saves the answer until Save is selected.

What is and is not professionally completed

Team review of a communication observation does not establish formal therapeutic approval. A preparation packet supports a professional conversation. Formal consultant authoring, credential verification, consent, signatures and applicable committee approvals are separate processes, not functions completed by saving in these tools.

Before giving the device to someone else

Check the individual's name, explain that participation is optional, and offer help without choosing answers for them. Save wanted contributions, then leave the feature or sign out as appropriate. On a shared device, the record identifies the actual signed-in account rather than pretending the individual signed in.

For the testing release, confirm microphone permissions, audible read-aloud and print/PDF output on the actual device you intend to use. Use fictional test answers for this check.